PROFANE ATTACK

A strategy game for the Sharp PC-1500, PC-1500A and Tandy PC-2

Instructions – version 1.6

1. The game

The Cathodic Church (CC) – a fictional organisation – holds ten places, numbered 0 to 9: **Lourdes** (France), **Fatima** (Portugal), **Altotting** (Germany), **Santiago de Compostela** (Spain), **Jasna Gora** (Poland), **Avila** (Spain), **Loreto** (Italy), **Hohensalzburg** (Austria), **Weltenburg** (Germany) and the **Vatican**. Each place is defended by militants and keeps valuable relics and gold. You lead a small group of Satanists, who spew brimstones, and mercenaries, who hurl inverted crosses. New volunteers join you as you conquer places, and you can buy jihadists (steadfast and valiant warriors) and mercenaries. Conquer all ten places to win the war.

The first places are easy. Every next place is harder than the one before, and the last three, places 7, 8 and 9, are **the richest places**: they start with twice as many militants and twice as much gold, but not with twice as many relics, so what one of them gives you is not enough to conquer the next one. The richest of all is the Vatican (place 9). Every place also hides its own treasure.

2. What you need

- A Sharp **PC-1500A**, or a **PC-1500** or **Tandy PC-2** with a RAM module (CE-151 or larger). The recording holds the program without its REM lines (5532 bytes); with its variables it needs about 5.9 KB of memory, so it does not fit into a PC-1500 or PC-2 without a module.
- To load the recording: the **CE-150** printer/cassette interface (for the PC-2: the Radio Shack printer/cassette interface) and a computer, phone or player that can play WAV files.

3. Loading the game

1. Switch off the computer, insert it into the CE-150 and connect the audio output of the computer or player to the **EAR** jack of the CE-150.
2. Switch on, select PRO mode and type `NEW0` [ENTER], then `CLOAD` [ENTER].
3. Play `profane_attack-v1.7.wav` (name on the tape: `PROFANE`, about 7 minutes). If the program does not load, try again with another volume.
4. Select RUN mode and type `RUN` [ENTER].

You can also type in the listing `profane_attack-v1.7.txt`. Leave out the REM lines: the recording does not contain them either, and with them the program would not leave enough memory for its variables on a PC-1500A. The place names and treasures in lines 970–986 contain small letters (SML key).

4. Start and main menu

The game shows `Starting..` while it prepares the places, then its title while it plays the opening of J.S. Bach's Toccata in D minor, then `CONQUER BASTIONS OF FAITH` and the main menu:

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FIGHT/BUY/SELL/RESOUR/END?
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Press one key, without ENTER:

Key	Action
F	Fight: attack a place (section 7)
B	Buy weapons, jihadists and mercenaries (section 8)
S	Sell relics, mercenaries and jihadists (section 9)
R	Show your resources (section 10)
E	End the game (section 11)

Other keys are ignored. Numbers (“HOW MANY…?”, and when buying or selling the number after the price) are typed and confirmed with ENTER. A wrong number gives a beep and the question again.

5. Your forces

At the start you have:

Resource	Start
Satanists	10
Mercenaries	5
Jihadists	0
Inverted crosses	20
Brimstones	4
Relics	0
Gold	1000

People

- **Satanists** (SAT on the display) spew the brimstones, hellish stones of demonic sulphur: each Satanist spews one brimstone in every round, so you can use only as many brimstones as you have Satanists. You cannot buy them: they join you when you conquer a place. The militants reach them only when no mercenaries are left.
- **Mercenaries** are needed to hurl the inverted crosses: each mercenary hurls one cross in every round, so you can use only as many crosses as you have mercenaries. They also stand in the front line: the militants strike them first. Every conquered place gives you new mercenaries, and you can also buy them.
- **Jihadists** fight on their own, without crosses or brimstones, in every fight, and stay with you until they are killed. Their killing power is monstrous: a jihadist who strikes eliminates 16 fighters. Groups of militants hunt them, and a jihadist who faces too many militants at once may fall.

Your people are Satanists + mercenaries + jihadists. When all of them are gone, the Cathodic Church (CC) wins.

Weapons

- **Inverted Cross:** instils terror among Cathodics. Only mercenaries can hurl inverted crosses, each mercenary one cross per round. A cross that hits eliminates one fighter in that round.
- **Brimstone:** a hellish stone of demonic sulphur, which terrifies Cathodics. Only Satanists can spew brimstones, each Satanist one brimstone per round. A brimstone that hits eliminates three fighters in that round.

Not every strike succeeds. You choose the crosses and brimstones for each fight; they are used up by that fight. In each round each mercenary can hurl one cross and each Satanist can spew one brimstone: more crosses or brimstones than that are wasted in that round.

6. The places

At the start of the game the places hold:

Place	Name	Militants	Relics	Gold
0	Lourdes	13	5	400
1	Fatima	22	9	300
2	Altotting	33	13	600
3	Santiago de C.	50	17	900
4	Jasna Gora	75	21	1200
5	Avila	115	25	1500
6	Loreto	182	29	1800
7	Hohensalzburg	588	33	4200
8	Weltenburg	976	37	4800
9	Vatican	1646	41	5400

Places 7, 8 and 9 (shaded) are the richest places.

7. Fight

1. Press **F**. The game asks `WHICH PLACE 0-9 (L=LIST)?`. Press the number of the place. **L** shows all places, one per second, e.g. `2 Altotting: 25 MIL` (militants still there) or `0 Lourdes: YOURS`. Any other key returns to the main menu.
2. The place is shown, two seconds per screen: `PLACE 3: Santiago de C.`, `50 MILITANTS`, `17 RELICS`, `900 GOLD`. If the place is already yours, the game shows e.g. `Lourdes IS YOURS` and asks for the place again.
3. `HOW MANY INV.CROSSES?` and `BRIMSTONES?`: type a number (0 is allowed) and ENTER. If you ask for more than you have, the game beeps, shows e.g. `YOU HAVE 20 CROSSES` and asks again. Without crosses, brimstones and jihadists you cannot fight: `NO WEAPONS!`.
4. `ENTER=FIGHT 3=RETREAT`: press **3** to retreat (you get your crosses and brimstones back) or **ENTER** to fight.
5. First `FIGHTING!` appears in the middle of the display; then your army and the militants march twice from both sides of the display, and each time they meet, the game beeps. Then the rounds begin.

Rounds

The fight is played in rounds:

- Your side strikes first: the crosses your mercenaries hurl (one per mercenary), the brimstones your Satanists spew (one per Satanist) and all your jihadists. The first strike is the weakest, because the militants are still behind their walls; from the second round on your weapons hit more often. However many weapons you take, at most a third of the militants the place had at the start of the fight fall in one strike: the others take cover. So the militants are eliminated step by step, in three strikes or more.
- Then the militants who are still alive strike back. Your mercenaries stand in the front line: the militants kill mercenaries, and only when no mercenaries are left they turn on the Satanists. Groups of militants can also kill jihadists, and when after your crosses and brimstones far more militants are left than you have jihadists, each jihadist may also fall.
- On the display, the game first shows `ROUND1: CC m vs YOU p` with both sides at full strength: the militants of the place and all your people. After every strike the next round (`ROUND2`, `ROUND3` …) shows what is left: the militants still alive after your strike and your people still alive after theirs. The last round shows `CC 0` when you win or `YOU 0` when you lose. Between `ROUND1` and `ROUND2` the game shows `Merc. hurl inv. crosses!` when

you fight with crosses and `Satanists spew brimstones!` when you fight with brimstones.

The same crosses and brimstones fight again in every round, until no militants or none of your people are left. A fight cannot be stopped once it has begun. The crosses and brimstones are used up whatever the result.

You won

A triumph melody plays while the first screen shows e.g. `YOU WON! Lourdes IS YOURS`. A longer place name does not fit on the display, so after the melody the line moves to the left until you can read its end. The line stays about 1.5 seconds after the melody, and the next screens follow by themselves, about 1.5 seconds each:

`YOU GOT g GOLD`
`r RELICS c CROSSES`

– You got all the gold and all the relics of the place, and some crosses (more at the higher places), which will serve as inverted crosses!

`AND ALSO YOU GOT:`

– Then the treasure of the place, e.g. `barrel of Holy Water` at Lourdes. Every place has its own treasure; it is a trophy and does not change your resources. You get it only the first time you conquer the place: when you win back a place that broke free, this screen is left out.

`LOST: m MERC s SAT j JIH`

– Your human losses in this fight.

`GOT y NEW MERC, z SAT`

– A sixth of the militants of the place join you as mercenaries. The more gold a place gives you, the more new Satanists join you, because Cathodic people were outraged by how much gold was stored there.

The place is now yours.

You lost

`YOU LOST!` appears in the middle of the display while a falling melody plays, and then it blinks three times. Your losses follow; these screens change by themselves, about 1.5 seconds each. The CC also takes some of your gold and relics: `LOST g GOLD, r RELICS`. As a fight only ends when one side has nobody left, a lost fight always means `NO ONE LEFT!` and `GAME OVER! Cathodics won`. Then, two seconds later, it shows `..but you have got...` and the treasure of the last place you conquered, or `lesson in humility..` if you have not conquered any. Meanwhile the second phrase of Bach's Toccata plays.

A place breaks free

Once you have conquered Loreto (place 6) or a higher place, the Cathodics start to fight back. From time to time, on the way back to the main menu (after a fight, after shopping and so on), one of your places rises against you: the game shows e.g. `Loreto broke free!` while the second phrase of Bach's Toccata plays; then the message blinks three times and the main menu comes back. It is never the place of your last fight. Its militants, relics and gold are back as at the start of the game, and you can conquer it again. To win the war, all ten places must be yours at the same time.

8. Buy

Press **B**. The game shows `C)ROSS B)RIM J)IHAD M)ERC`:

Key	Item	Price (gold)
C	Inverted cross	25
B	Brimstone	110
J	Jihadist	400

Key	Item	Price (gold)
M	Mercenary	80

The game shows the price and how many you can afford, e.g. `PRICE 25 (MAX 40) ?`. Type the number on the same line, right after the question mark, e.g. `PRICE 25 (MAX 40) ? 12`, and press ENTER (ENTER alone buys nothing). Any key other than a digit wipes the number, so you can type it again; more than you can afford gives a beep and the question again. If you cannot afford even one, the game beeps, shows `NOT ENOUGH GOLD` for a second and the buy menu comes back at once. After a purchase the buy menu comes back too: buy something else or press any other key to return to the main menu.

9. Sell

Press **S**. The game first shows what you have to sell, e.g. `REL 9 MERC 12 JIH 2` (relics, mercenaries, jihadists) and waits until you press any key. Then it asks `SELL R)EL M)ERC J)IHAD?`:

Key	Item	Price (gold)
R	Relic	random
M	Mercenary	50
J	Jihadist	320

Press **R**, **M** or **J**; any other key returns to the main menu. The game shows the price of one piece and how many you have, e.g. `PRICE 320 (MAX 2) ?`. Type the number right after the question mark, as when buying, and press ENTER (ENTER alone sells nothing). Then it shows `GOLD NOW g` and the sell menu comes back.

The price of a relic is random. It stays the same until your next fight and then changes. Mercenaries and jihadists sell for less than they cost. You cannot sell your last people: the game shows `KEEP SOMEONE!`. If you have none of the chosen item, it shows `NOTHING TO SELL`.

10. Resources

Press R. After YOU HAVE: the game shows your people (SAT, MERC, JIHAD), your weapons (CROSS, BRIMSTONES), then your GOLD and RELICS, one screen at a time. Press any key to see the next screen; after the last one the main menu comes back.

11. End

Press **E**. `QUIT (Y/N)?`: **Y** ends the game and shows your gold (`BYE! GOLD g`); any other key returns to the main menu.

12. Winning and losing

- You win the war when all ten places are yours: `ALL BASTIONS ARE YOURS!` and `YOU BEAT THE CATHODICS!`. The second message appears by itself while the whole opening of Bach's Toccata plays; then the display is cleared and the game ends.
- You lose when none of your people are left: `GAME OVER! Cathodics won`.

13. Tips

- Every element counts. Crosses are the cheapest, but only your mercenaries can hurl them, one each per round; brimstones need Satanists, one each per round; jihadists need nobody. Crosses or brimstones that nobody can throw are wasted, and at most a third of the militants fall in one strike. A player who leaves out any of crosses, brimstones, jihadists, mercenaries or Satanists wins clearly less often.

- Your income is the gold and the relics of the conquered places. Sell relics when the price is good; if it is low, keep them: the price changes after your next fight.
- Save gold and relics from the first places for the rich places 7, 8 and 9: each of them is a big step up, and what one of them gives you is not enough for the next one. If you use up all your gold in every fight, you will not get through Weltenburg and the Vatican.
- Jihadists are expensive, but monstrous, and they fight again in every following fight. Do not let them be outnumbered too far: the militants left after your crosses and brimstones decide how many of them survive.
- Mercenaries stand in the front line: as long as you have enough of them, the militants' blows do not reach your Satanists, and your brimstones keep coming.
- Surplus mercenaries and jihadists can be sold for gold, but every mercenary you sell is one fewer to hurl crosses and to take the militants' blows.
- The mercenaries you win are your reserve of people and of cross-throwers. Check your forces with R and the places with L before you attack.
- Changed your mind before the fight? Press **3** to retreat: you lose nothing.